

EXPERIMENT – 2

SETTING UP A ZOHO CREATOR ACCOUNT AND EXPLORING THE PLATFORM ARCHITECTURE AND INTERFACE

1. AIM

To set up a Zoho Creator account, create and explore a sample application, and understand the creation of forms, reports and dashboards. The experiment also aims to explore the basic platform architecture and interface through the Develop, Deploy and Manage stages.

2. SETTING UP ZOHO CREATOR

I) Creating the Sample Application

Zoho Creator is a low-code application development platform that allows users to create data-driven applications with minimal programming. It provides components such as forms, reports, pages, dashboards and workflows for developing applications.

For this experiment, a sample application named **Student Activity Management** was created.

Procedure

1. Open Zoho Creator and sign in using a Zoho account.
2. Create a new application from the Zoho Creator application builder.
3. Name the application **Student Activity Management**.
4. Open the application in the Edit/Design mode.
5. Create a form named **Student Details**.
6. Add the required fields to collect student activity information.
7. Enter sample student records using the created form.
8. View the submitted records using the automatically generated report.
9. Create a page named **Student Activity Dashboard**.
10. Add a chart and the student details report to the dashboard.

The screenshot displays the 'Student Activity Management' application. The left sidebar features a dark theme with a 'SAM' logo and a menu where 'Student Details' is highlighted. The main content area, titled 'Student Details', contains a form with the following fields: 'Student Name' (text input), 'Register Number' (text input), 'Department' (dropdown menu showing '-Select-'), 'Year' (dropdown menu showing '-Select-'), 'Email' (text input), 'Activity' (text input), and 'Activity Date' (text input with a date mask 'dd-MMM-yyyy'). A blue 'Submit' button is positioned at the bottom right of the form.

Student Activity Management Application

Explanation:

The screenshot shows the successfully created **Student Activity Management** application in Zoho Creator. The application acts as the main container for the forms, reports and dashboard used in this experiment.

II) Creating the Form

A form is used to collect and store information from users. In this experiment, a form named **Student Details** was created to collect student information and their participation in different activities.

Fields Used

Field Name	Field Type
Student Name	Single Line
Register Number	Single Line
Department	Dropdown
Year	Dropdown
Email	Email

Field Name	Field Type
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Activity	Single Line
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Activity Date	Date
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Procedure

1. Open the **Student Activity Management** application.
2. Select the option to add a new form.
3. Create a blank form.
4. Name the form **Student Details**.
5. Add Student Name, Register Number, Department, Year, Email, Activity and Activity Date fields.
6. Configure the required field values.
7. Save the form.
8. Enter sample student records using the form.

The screenshot shows the Zoho Creator interface for the 'Student Activity Management' application. The 'Student Details' form is being configured. On the left, the 'Basic Fields' panel lists various field types: Name, Email, Address, Phone, Single Line, Multi Line, Number, Date, Time, Drop Down, Radio, and Multi Select. The main area displays the form fields: Student Name, Register Number, Department, Year, Email, Activity, and Activity Date. On the right, the 'Field Properties' panel shows configuration options for the selected 'Student Name' field, including Field name, Field link name, Validation, Initial value, Character maximum, Data Privacy, and Data Security.

Explanation:

The Student Details form is used to collect student information and activity details. The submitted information is stored as records in the Zoho Creator application and can later be displayed through reports and dashboards.

III) Creating and Viewing the Report

A report is used to display the records collected through a form in an organized manner. Zoho Creator provides a report for the records submitted through the Student Details form.

The report created for this experiment is:

All Student Details

The report contains information such as:

- Student Name
- Register Number
- Department
- Year
- Email
- Activity
- Activity Date

Sample Records

The following sample student records were entered into the application:

Student Name	Register Number	Department	Year	Activity
Rithish A S	240701007	AIDS	3rd	Hackathon
Livya Remi Rosi E	240701289	CSE	3rd	Event
Keerthana R	240701256	CSE	3rd	Event
Keerthana VV	240701257	CSE	3rd	Hackathon

Student Name	Register Number	Department	Year	Email	Activity	Activity Date
Rithish A S	240701007	AIDS	3rd	rithishkumar@gmail.com	Hackathon	04-Aug-2026
Livya Remi Rosi E	240701289	CSE	3rd	livyaremirosi0@gmail.com	Event	08-Aug-2026
Keerthana R	240701256	CSE	3rd	keerthanakeerthu1928@gmail.com	Event	07-Aug-2026
Keerthana VV	240701257	CSE	3rd	keerthanavsarathy@gmail.com	Hackathon	07-Aug-2026

Explanation:

The **All Student Details** report displays the records submitted through the Student Details form in an organized tabular format. It allows users to view student information, department, year, activity and activity date in a single interface.

IV) Creating the Dashboard

A dashboard provides a centralized view of important application information. In Zoho Creator, a page can be used to combine reports, charts and other components into a single interface.

For this experiment, a page named **Student Activity Dashboard** was created.

Components Used

1. **Pie Chart – Student Details**
2. **All Student Details Report**

The pie chart visually represents the distribution of student activities such as **Event** and **Hackathon**. The report component provides access to the detailed student records.

Procedure

1. Open the application in Edit mode.
2. Create a new page.
3. Name the page **Student Activity Dashboard**.
4. Add a Chart component.
5. Select Student Details as the data source.
6. Configure the chart to display activity information.
7. Add the **All Student Details** report to the page.
8. Save and preview the dashboard.

Student Activity Management

SAM Student Activity Management

Student Details

Student Details

All Student Details

Student Activity Dashboard

Student Details

Student Name

Register Number

Department

Year

Email

Activity

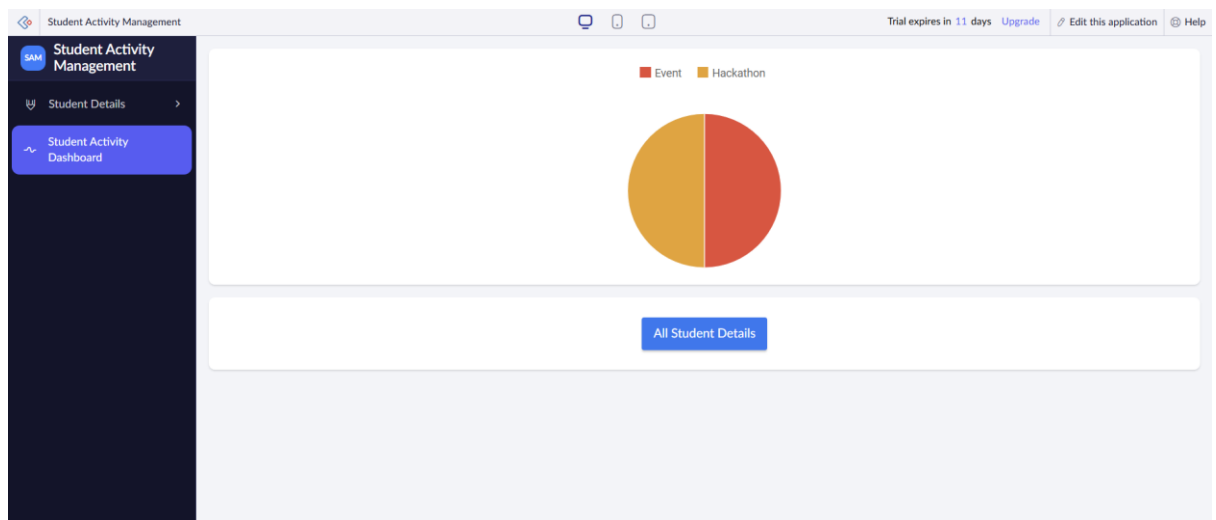
Activity Date

-Select-

-Select-

dd-MMM-yyyy

Submit



3. EXPLORING THE PLATFORM ARCHITECTURE AND INTERFACE

Zoho Creator provides a low-code application development environment. The platform can be understood through three major stages: **Develop, Deploy and Manage**.

A) DEVELOP

1. The Develop stage is used to create forms, reports, pages and workflows.
2. It allows developers to design the application interface and configure its components.
3. The application can be tested, modified and improved during the development process.

B) DEPLOY

1. The Deploy stage is used to make the completed application available to users.
2. The application can be moved through testing and production stages when required.
3. Authorized users can access the application after it is deployed.

C) MANAGE

1. The Manage stage is used to control application settings, users and permissions.
2. Administrators can manage application configurations and access controls.
3. It helps maintain and control the application after deployment.

Basic Platform Architecture

The basic application lifecycle can be represented as:

DEVELOP → DEPLOY → MANAGE

DEVELOP

Application creation, forms, reports, pages, workflows and testing.

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DEPLOY

Application publishing, testing and providing access to authorized users.

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MANAGE

User management, permissions, settings and application maintenance.

4. RESULT

Thus, a sample application named **Student Activity Management** was successfully created using Zoho Creator. The **Student Details** form was created and sample records were entered. The **All Student Details** report was explored and a **Student Activity Dashboard** containing a chart and report was created successfully.

The basic Zoho Creator platform architecture and interface involving **Develop, Deploy and Manage** were also studied.

5. CONCLUSION

Zoho Creator provides a simple low-code environment for developing data-driven applications. Forms are used to collect data, reports are used to display and organize records, and dashboards provide a visual representation of important information. The Develop, Deploy and Manage stages help in building, publishing and maintaining applications effectively.